

Turning the Light On

The Progressive Era • 1890–1920 | Standards US.08, US.09, US.10, US.11, US.12, US.13, US.14, US.15, US.16, US.17, US.18

Name _____

- Archive (J. Troop)
- Spark
- Navigator
- Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

When a booming country leaves millions behind, who decides to fix it — and how? Progressive-era Americans fought over whether the answer was charity, protest, journalism, unions, or the government itself. Which of them actually moved the country?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories.

Social Darwinism	_____	muckraker	_____
	_____		_____
trust	_____	collective bargaining	_____
	_____		_____
suffrage	_____	initiative & referendum	_____
	_____		_____

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Your read & evidence
1	Analyze Social Darwinism as a justification for inequality, and compare Washington's and Du Bois's strategies for Black advancement. Notice: Somebody tells you the rich are rich because they're simply better — stronger, smarter, more deserving — and the poor earned their poverty by... Debrief: Washington and Du Bois wanted the same goal but chose opposite strategies. Explain each strategy in one sentence, then argue which one you think fit the dangers of 1900 better — using evidence.	
2	Explain how farmers (Granger/Populist) and workers (labor unions) organized to fight railroads and industry — and what it cost them. Notice: One company sets the price, and you have no choice but to pay it — sound familiar? For Anna's family, that company was the railroad, and the price... Debrief: Farmers and industrial workers used different tactics but shared one core idea. Name the shared idea, then give one tactic each group used and one risk each faced.	
3	Analyze how trusts concentrated power, and how Roosevelt's Square Deal and Wilson's New Freedom used government to check it. Notice: Imagine one company owns the app, the phone, the store, and the road to the store — so there's nowhere else to go and no price but theirs. That... Debrief: Trace one path from problem to fix: start with the power of the trusts, and explain how journalism and government together checked it. Name at least one muckraker and one law or agency.	
4	Analyze industrial working conditions — child labor, sweatshops, and the Triangle fire — and the reforms they provoked. Notice: 146 people went to work one morning and never came home — most of them girls not much older than you, some younger. The factory doors were locked... Debrief: The Triangle fire is often called a turning point. Explain what conditions caused so many deaths, and how the tragedy changed what the government required of factories.	
5	Explain how muckrakers exposed abuses and mobilized public support for reform. Notice: You post a video of something wrong — a scam, a cover-up — and by morning it's everywhere and somebody powerful has to answer for it. That... Debrief: Explain how a single book led to a federal law in 1906 — and why Sinclair considered the result a partial failure.	
6	Analyze Progressive democratic reforms that expanded citizen control (initiative, referendum, recall, direct primaries, 16th & 17th Amendments). Notice: What if you could skip the middleman and vote directly on the rule itself — no crooked politician required? That's not a fantasy app. It's what... Debrief: Choose two Progressive democratic reforms and explain how each one shifted power away from political machines or state legislatures and toward ordinary citizens.	
7	Analyze the women's suffrage movement and the ratification of the 19th Amendment — decided in Tennessee. Notice: It comes down to one vote. One state left to make women's suffrage the law of the land, and that state is Tennessee. The count is tied. And the... Debrief: The 19th Amendment is a triumph and an unfinished one. Explain how women won the vote (including Tennessee's deciding role) AND why the victory was incomplete for many Black women.	

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 2 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **dubois-souls**

- 1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
- 2. Spark's question: *Both men were brilliant, brave, and right about some things. Instead of picking a 'winner,' ask: what did each strategy risk, and what did each...*
- 3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Toward ↗ or away ↘?	Why — your evidence
1892	Homestead Strike crushed		
1895	Atlanta Compromise (Washington)		
1906	Pure Food & Drug and Meat Inspection Acts		
1911	Triangle Shirtwaist fire		
1913	17th Amendment (direct election of senators)		
1914	Clayton Act & Federal Trade Commission		
1920	19th Amendment ratified in Tennessee		

B Debrief & Closing Argument

If Unit 1 was the country growing fast and leaving people behind, Unit 2 is the country arguing about what it owes the people it left. Watch...

Closing question: Across this unit you saw at least five kinds of power try to fix a broken system: charity, protest, unions, journalism, and the law. Pick the two you think actually moved the country the most, cite evidence from the unit, and defend your ranking. There's no answer key — make the case.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now: